

GLOBAL AI CONFERENCE · KEYNOTE SESSION

# Advanced Generative AI Image Generation Capabilities

From random noise to vivid imagination — how machines learned to paint what we describe, and where the frontier is heading.



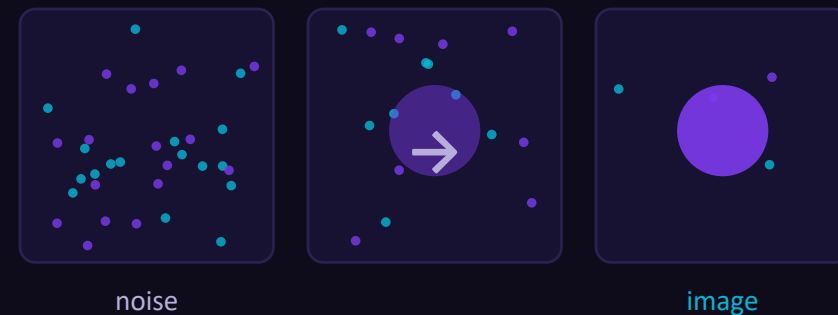
*Designed for every level — first-time learners to seasoned practitioners.*



## WHY THIS MATTERS

# You typed a sentence. The machine painted it.

A decade ago, turning a phrase into a photorealistic image needed an artist and days of work. Today it takes a sentence and a few seconds. That shift is not a better paintbrush — it is a fundamentally new way for machines to understand and create.



~30s

from prompt to a 4K image on today's frontier models

3

questions any image model must answer — the spine of this talk

**Text**→**Pixels**

now one shared problem, not two separate worlds

THE ONE IDEA TO HOLD ONTO

# Three questions every image model must answer

Strip away the jargon and every text-to-image system is solving the same three problems. We will spend the session on each — in this order.



## PART 1

### How do I imagine?

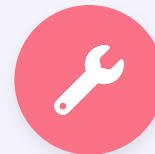
Turn a blank canvas of pure noise into a coherent picture. This is the diffusion engine.



## PART 2

### How do I understand words?

Map a sentence and a picture into the same space so 'meaning' can steer the brush. This is embeddings & CLIP.



## PART 3

### What can I actually do?

Create, edit, upscale, restyle — and where the frontier is heading in 2026.

# Where we are going



## The Engine — Diffusion

01

Noise, denoising, latent space, and the Stable Diffusion pipeline



## The Translator — Words ↔ Pixels

02

Embedding spaces, CLIP, contrastive learning, autoencoders



## Capabilities & the Frontier

03

What models do today, how architectures evolved, the 2026 landscape



## Hands-On & Takeaways

04

Two live demos and the mental model to carry home

PART 1

# The Engine: Diffusion

How a model turns pure static into a picture — the single most important idea in modern image generation.



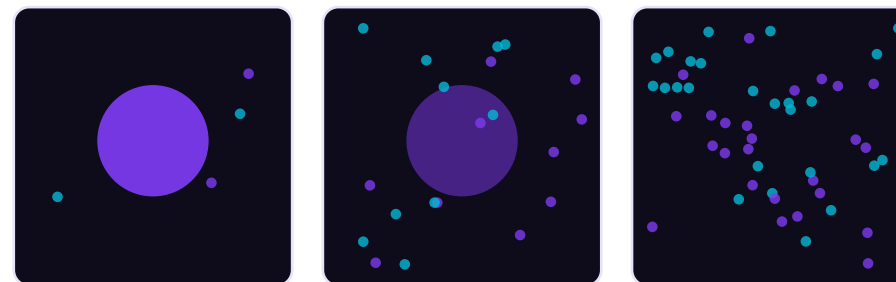
## THE CORE TRICK

# Sculpting an image out of chaos

Imagine a sculptor staring at a rough block of marble. They don't add stone — they remove what isn't the statue. Diffusion models work the same way. They start from a canvas of pure random noise and, step by step, remove what isn't the picture until an image emerges.



**The mental model:** Generation is denoising, run in reverse. Teach a network to clean up noisy images, then ask it to clean up nothing but noise — and it hallucinates a brand-new image.

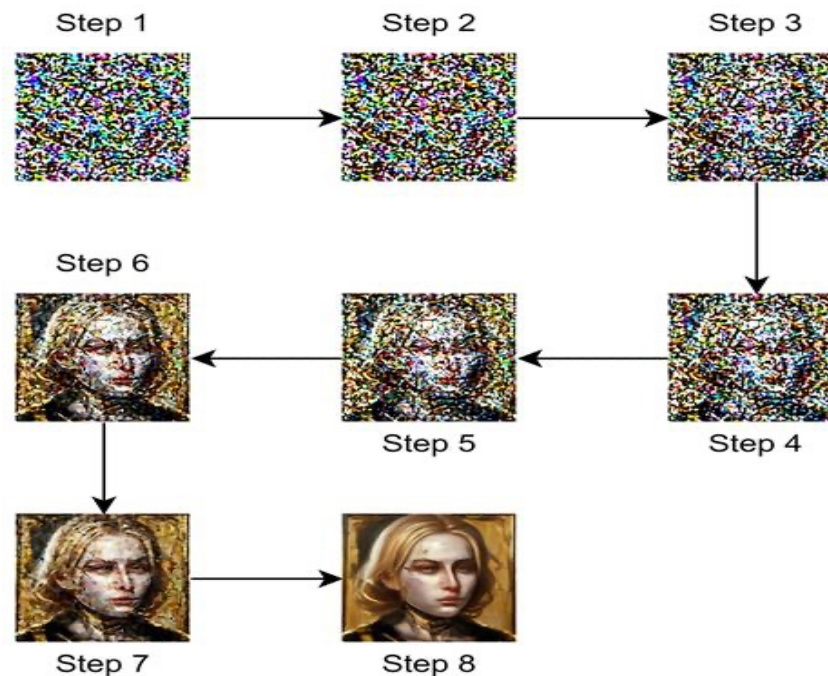


clear image

pure noise

→ add noise (forward / training)

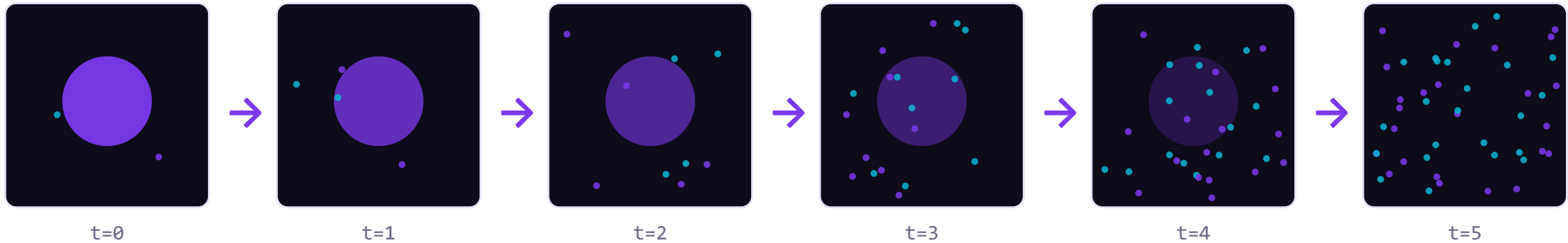
← remove noise (reverse / generate)



## STEP 1 OF THE RECIPE

# Learning by destroying: the forward process

Before a model can rebuild images, we deliberately wreck them. We take a clean training image and add a tiny bit of random noise — then a little more, then more — over many steps, until nothing is left but static. Crucially, we record exactly how much noise we added at each step.



**Why bother?** Each noisy-vs-cleaner pair becomes a free training example. The model sees millions of them and learns one skill: given a noisy image, predict the noise that was added.



# FORWARD NOISING PROCESS

Gradually adding noise to data until it becomes pure random noise

## STEP 1

Noise Level: 0%



Original  
Image

## STEP 2

Noise Level: 20%



Slight noise added,  
details mostly clear

## STEP 3

Noise Level: 40%



Moderate noise,  
some details lost

## STEP 4

Noise Level: 60%



High noise,  
details hard to see

## STEP 5

Noise Level: 80%



Very high noise,  
image barely  
recognizable

## STEP 6

Noise Level: 100%



Pure random noise,  
no information  
remains

0%  
(Clean Data)



Increasing Noise

100%  
(Pure Noise)

## STEP 2 OF THE RECIPE

# The real magic: the reverse process

Now flip it. Hand the trained network a frame of pure noise and a prompt. It predicts the noise, subtracts a slice of it, and repeats — dozens of times. Each pass reveals a little more structure, like a photo developing in a darkroom.

1

1 • Predict

The network estimates: how much of this is noise, and what shape lies underneath?

2

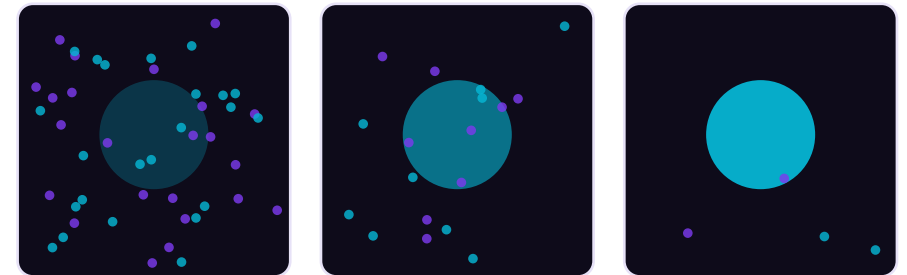
2 • Subtract

Remove a controlled fraction of that predicted noise — never all at once.

3

3 • Repeat

Loop the prediction-and-subtract step until a clean image remains.



← fewer noise, more image

*The prompt steers every step — that is where words become pictures (Part 2).*



# REVERSE DIFFUSION: BRINGING IMAGES BACK TO LIFE

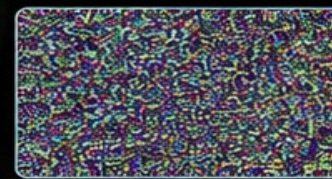
Like a photo emerging in the darkroom, reverse diffusion gradually transforms random noise into a coherent image.



## AI CONNECTION

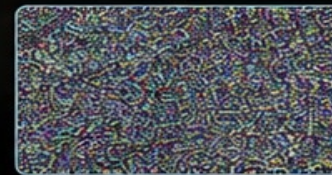
Reverse diffusion models learn to undo noise, reconstructing data one step at a time.

## THE PROCESS: NOISE TO IMAGE



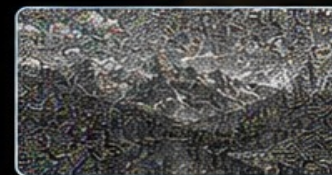
### STEP 1

Random Noise  
No structure,  
pure randomness



### STEP 2

Early Structure  
Basic patterns  
begin to form



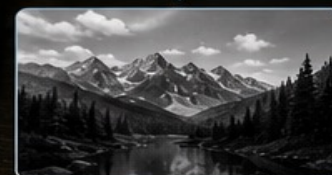
### STEP 3

Shapes Appear  
Edges and forms  
become visible



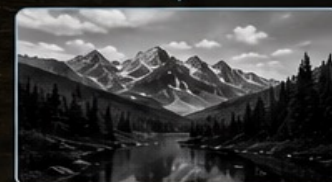
### STEP 4

Details Emerge  
Textures and details  
are refined



### STEP 5

Almost There  
Image is mostly  
restored



### STEP 6

Image Restored  
Clear, coherent  
image achieved

## THE EFFICIENCY BREAKTHROUGH

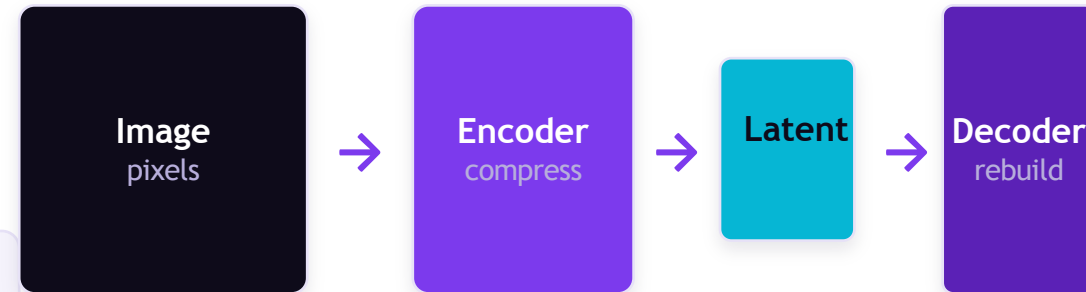
# Think in concepts, not pixels: latent space

Denoising a full-resolution image millions of times would be brutally expensive. The breakthrough behind Stable Diffusion was to do the work in a compressed 'latent' space — a small, meaning-rich summary of the image instead of every pixel.



### Analogy: a recipe, not the dish

You don't memorize a meal bite-by-bite — you remember the recipe. A latent code is the recipe of an image: far smaller, but enough to reconstruct the dish. Diffusion runs on the recipe, then a decoder cooks the full picture.



*Diffusion happens HERE — in the small latent*

~48× smaller to process



# COMPRESSION & RECONSTRUCTION

Complex data can be compressed into compact representations  
and reconstructed with high fidelity



## COMPRESS

Reduce data to essential information

COMPRESSED REPRESENTATION (LOWER INFORMATION)



### HERB ROASTED SALMON

with Asparagus & Lemon Cream

🕒 30 min | 👤 2 servings | 📊 Medium

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#### INGREDIENTS

- 2 salmon fillets
- 1 bunch asparagus
- 1 cup cherry tomatoes
- 1/2 cup heavy cream
- 1 lemon
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- 2 garlic cloves
- Salt & pepper
- Fresh herbs (thyme, parsley)

#### STEPS

1. Preheat oven to 400°F (200°C).
2. Season salmon with salt, pepper, and herbs.
3. Toss asparagus and tomatoes with olive oil, salt, and pepper.
4. Roast salmon, asparagus, and tomatoes for 12–15 min.
5. Make lemon cream: sauté garlic, add cream and lemon zest.
6. Serve salmon over cream sauce with roasted vegetables.



## RECONSTRUCT

Rebuild high-fidelity output from compressed information



### KEY TAKEAWAY

Compression captures the essence.  
Reconstruction restores the experience.

## PUTTING IT TOGETHER

# The Stable Diffusion engine, assembled

Three components, one pipeline. A text encoder turns your prompt into meaning; a denoiser (the U-Net or, today, a Transformer) sculpts the latent guided by that meaning; a decoder turns the finished latent into pixels.

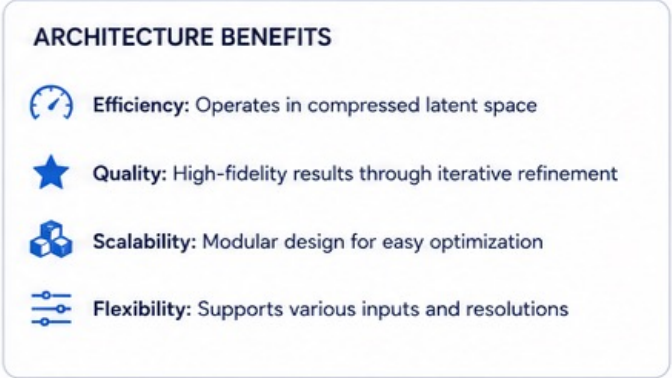
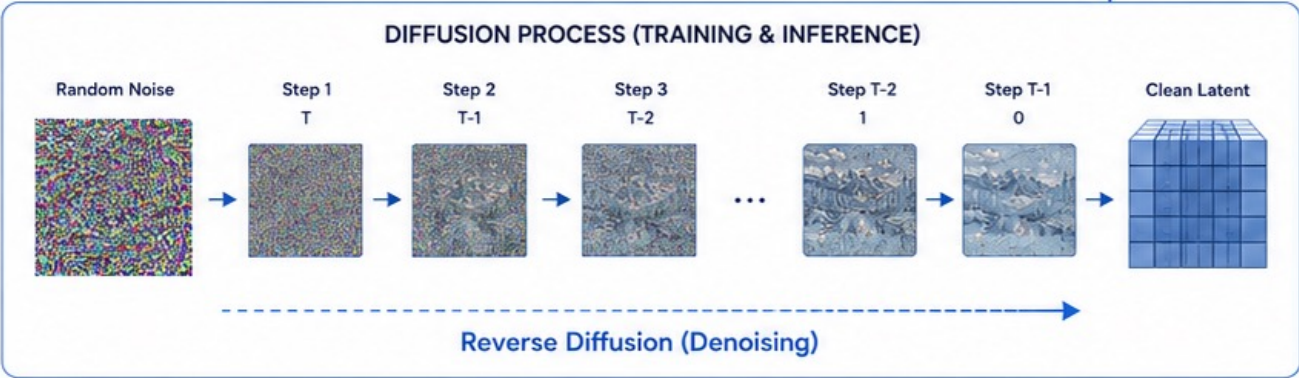
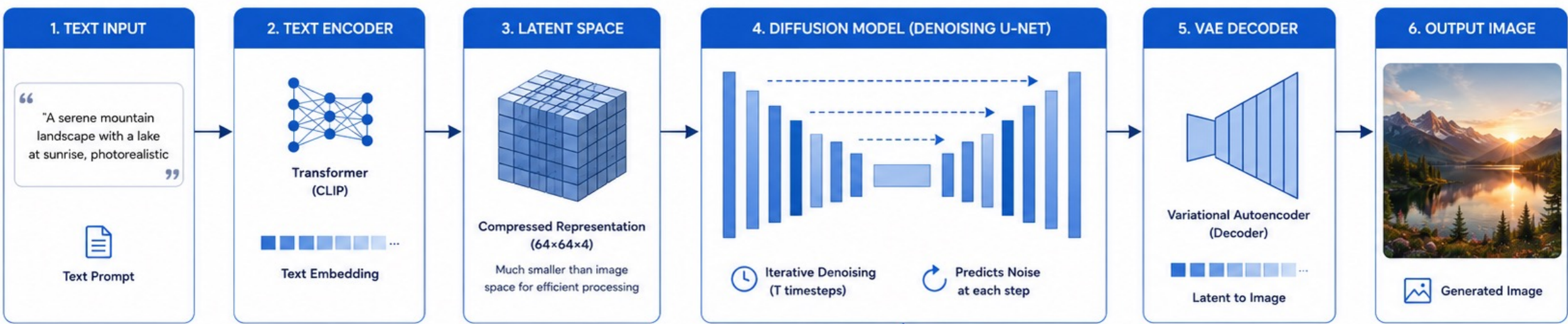


**Open-source matters:** because weights and code are public, this exact pipeline spawned an entire ecosystem — fine-tunes, LoRAs, ControlNets, and the FLUX / SDXL families we'll meet in Part 3.



# MODERN DIFFUSION MODEL ARCHITECTURE

Transforming Text Prompts into High-Quality Images



THE ONE DIAL THAT CHANGES EVERYTHING

# Denoising strength: your creative throttle

When you edit or transform an existing image, one parameter decides how far the model strays from the original: denoising strength. Too low and nothing changes; too high and the original is lost. The art is finding the balance.



## Low (0.2-0.4)

Subtle touch-ups. Keeps composition, colour, identity. Great for restoration.

## Mid (0.5-0.7)

Reinterpret while honouring the source. The sweet spot for style transfer.

## High (0.8-1.0)

Bold reinvention. The prompt dominates; the original is just a seed.



## MAKING IT FAST

# From 1000 steps to a handful

Early diffusion models (DDPM) needed up to a thousand tiny denoising steps — accurate but painfully slow. DDIM and later samplers showed you can take bigger, smarter strides and reach near-identical quality in a fraction of the steps.

DDPM



~1000 small steps · slow

DDIM +



~20–50 big steps · fast & deterministic

**Why you should care:** fewer steps = lower cost and real-time interaction. This single advance is what turned diffusion from a research curiosity into a product you can ship.

## PART 2

# The Translator: Words ↔ Pixels

The engine can sculpt — but how does a sentence steer the chisel? The answer is shared meaning.



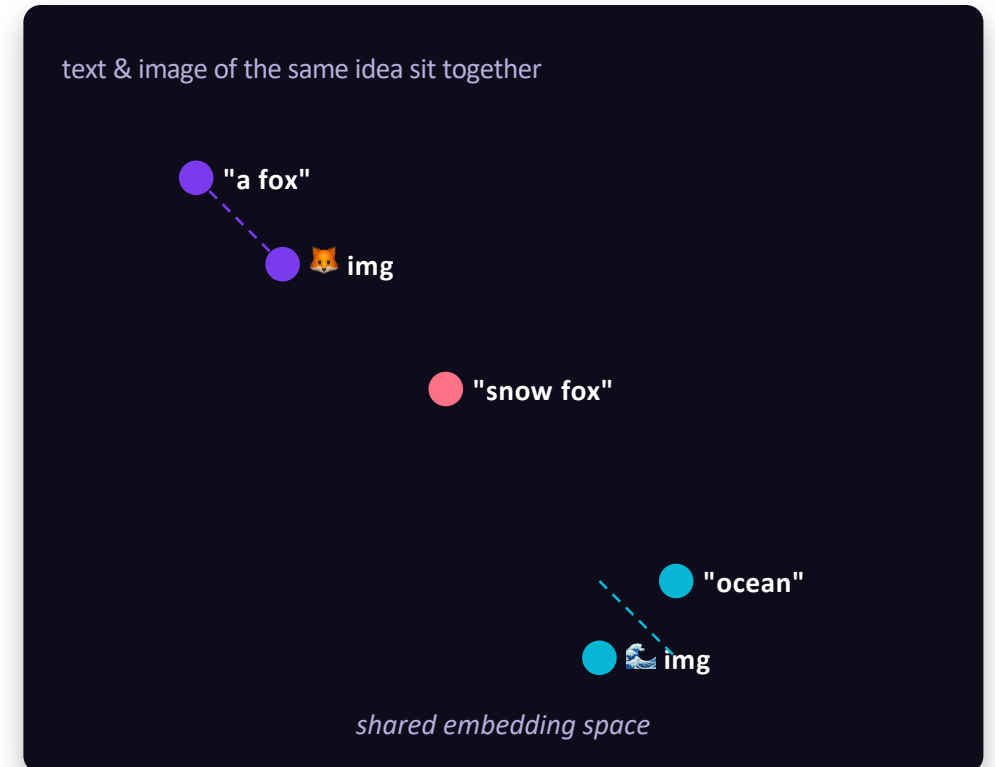
## THE BIG IDEA OF PART 2

# A shared map for words and pictures

Computers don't understand 'fox' or recognise a photo directly. They turn both into vectors — long lists of numbers. The trick: train so that a picture of a fox and the word 'fox' land in nearly the same spot on one shared map. Closeness on the map means closeness in meaning.



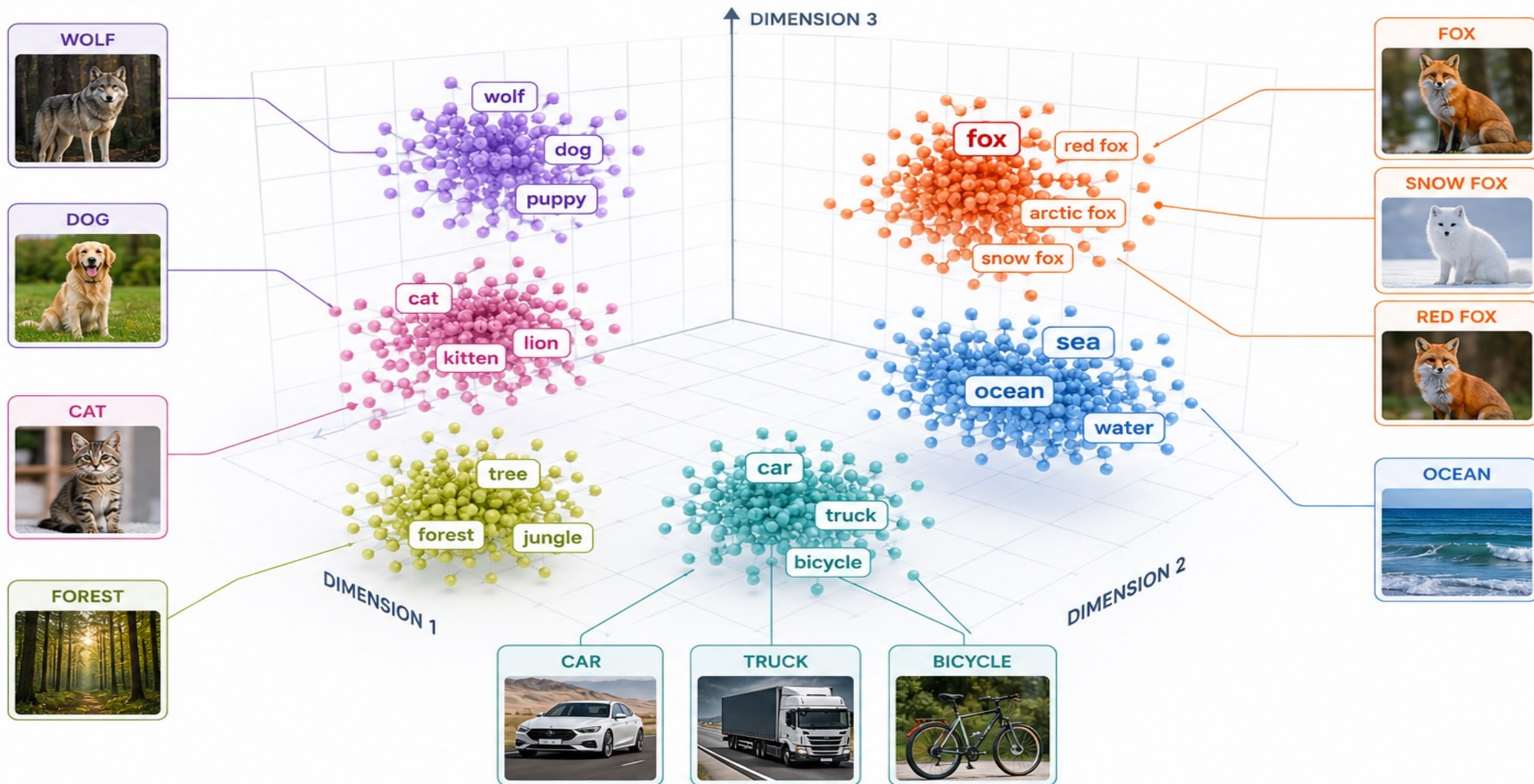
**Why it's powerful:** once text and images share a map, you can search images with words, caption pictures, and — critically — let a prompt pull the diffusion process toward the right region of image-space.





# 3D SEMANTIC EMBEDDING SPACE

Words and images with similar meaning are closer together in this high-dimensional space



## HOW THE MAP GETS BUILT

# CLIP: teaching text and images one language

CLIP learns the shared map by studying hundreds of millions of image–caption pairs from the web. It runs each image through an image encoder and each caption through a text encoder, then nudges matching pairs together and mismatched pairs apart.

### ✓ Two encoders, one goal

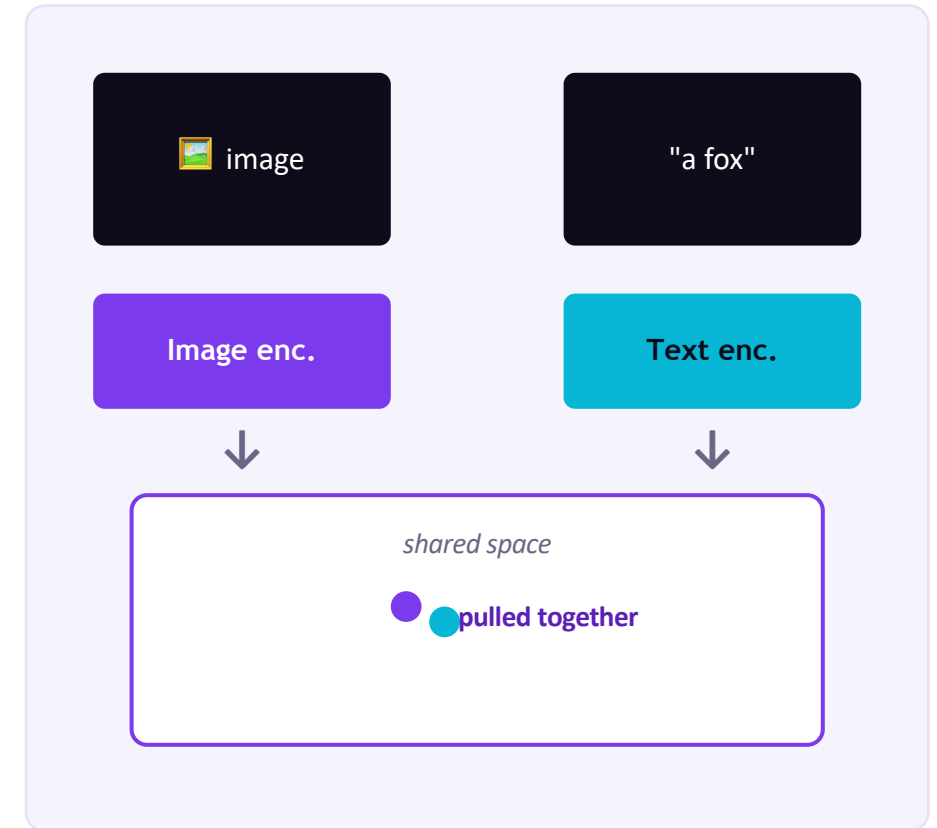
Image encoder and text encoder produce vectors in the same space.

### ✓ Match vs. mismatch

Correct image–caption pairs are pulled close; wrong pairs are pushed away.

### ✓ No hand-labels needed

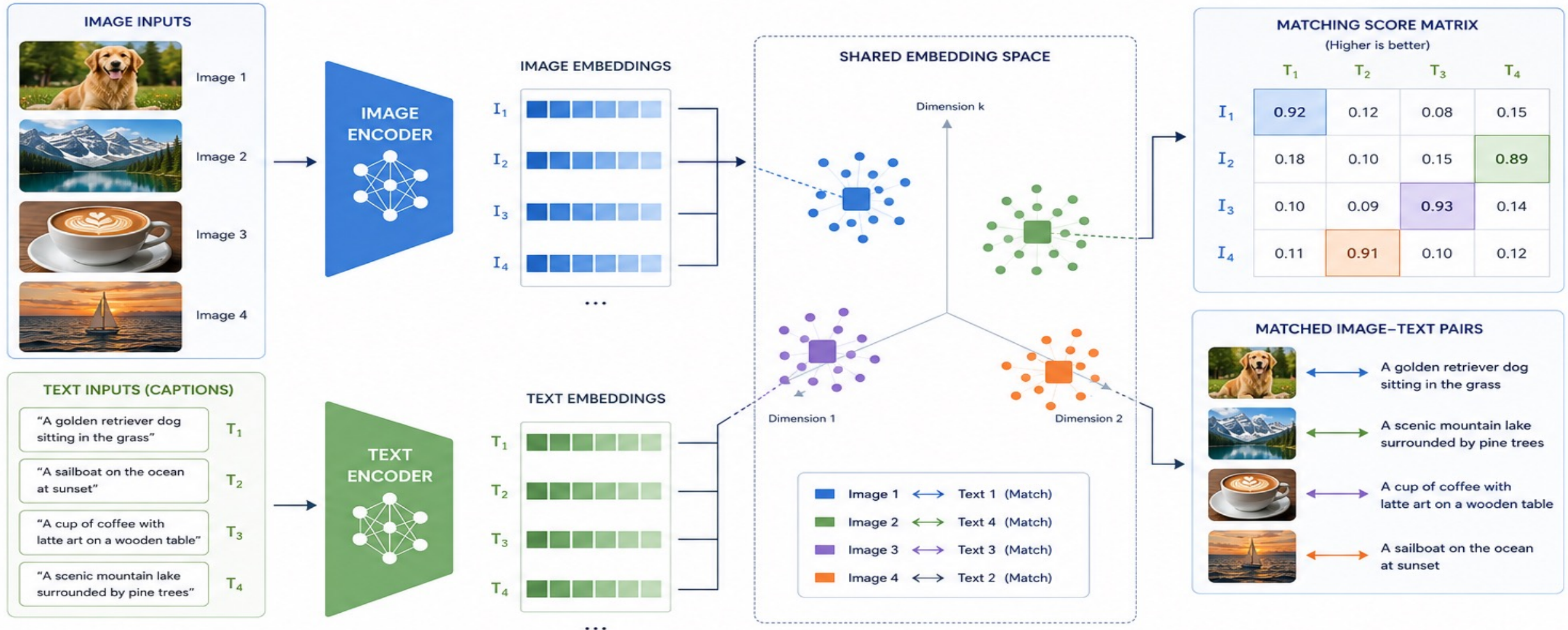
The web's alt-text is the supervision — so it scales to internet size.





# IMAGE AND TEXT ENCODERS WITH SHARED EMBEDDING SPACE

Mapping images and text into a common semantic space for understanding and matching



## SEMANTIC ALIGNMENT

Images and text with similar meaning are close in the shared space.



## MULTIMODAL UNDERSTANDING

Enables cross-modal retrieval, classification, and zero-shot learning.



## SCALABLE & EFFICIENT

Encoders map high-dimensional data to compact, meaningful embeddings.



## ROBUST & GENERALIZABLE

Learns rich semantic representations that transfer across tasks and domains.

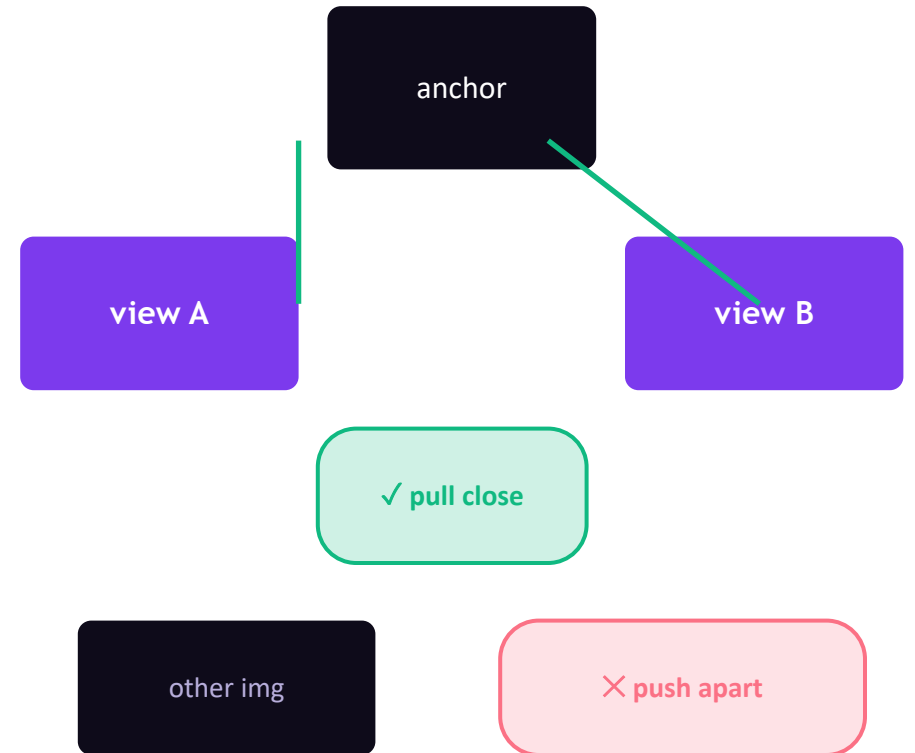
# Contrastive learning: understanding by comparison

How do you teach meaning without labels? Show the model what is alike and what is different. Take one image, create two altered views of it (crop, flip, recolour) — those are a positive pair and should match. Every other image is a negative — it should not.

**Pull together** the two views of the same image.

**Push apart** views of different images. Repeat billions of times.

**SimCLR** made this famous; the same family powers CLIP. The payoff: rich features learned from unlabeled data.





# Autoencoders & VAEs: meaningful compression

Remember the encoder/decoder from latent space? That's an autoencoder — a network that squeezes data down to its essence and rebuilds it. Variational autoencoders (VAEs) go further: they organise the compressed space so it's smooth and samplable, which is exactly what generation needs.



## Autoencoder

Encoder compresses → bottleneck → decoder reconstructs. Learns what to keep and what to drop.



## VAE

Adds structure so nearby points decode to similar images — a space you can smoothly sample and interpolate.



## Why it matters here

The VAE is the encoder/decoder of Stable Diffusion — and contrastive learning sharpens what those embeddings mean.

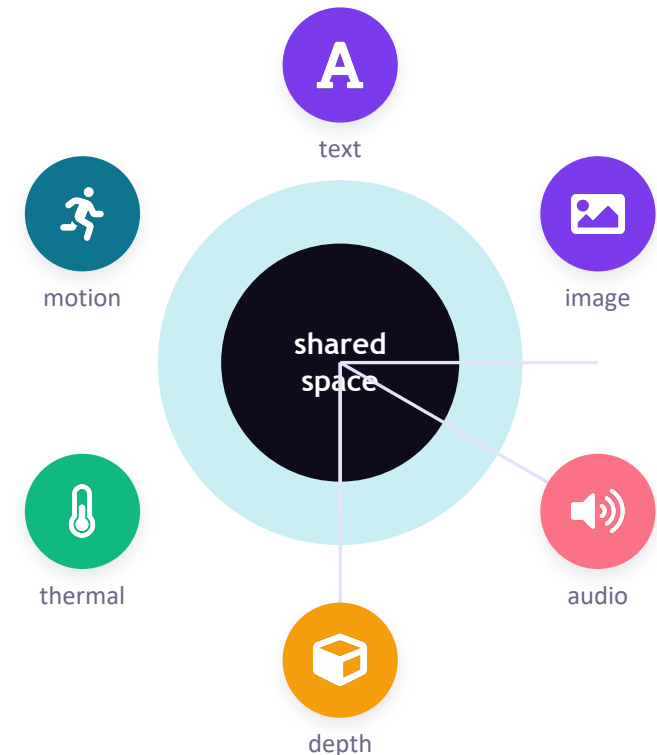
## WHERE THIS IS HEADING

# Beyond text + image: one space for everything

If text and images can share a map, why stop there? Research like ImageBind binds many modalities — audio, depth, thermal, motion — into a single embedding space, often without paired data for every combination. The result: search and generate across senses.

### What this unlocks

- Hum a tune → get a matching image
- Search a photo library with a sound
- Compose meaning with arithmetic: 'dog' + 'bark' ≈ barking dog
- Cross-modal retrieval & generation in one model



# MULTIMODAL DATA → SHARED AI UNDERSTANDING

Bringing Together Diverse Data Modalities to Form a Unified Representation of the World



## TEXT

"The astronaut examines the planetary landscape before sunrise."



## IMAGE



## AUDIO



## DEPTH



## THERMAL



## MOTION



## SHARED AI UNDERSTANDING SPACE

Unified, Contextual Representation

## ENABLED UNDERSTANDING & APPLICATIONS



### SEMANTIC UNDERSTANDING

The astronaut is exploring a rocky planet surface at sunrise.



### SCENE COMPREHENSION

Environment, objects, lighting, and spatial relationships are understood.



### EVENT RECOGNITION

The scene captures a moment of exploration and discovery in an alien world.



### SPATIAL AWARENESS

Depth, structure, and geometry enable 3D understanding and navigation.



### DECISION MAKING

Supports planning, prediction, and safe actions in complex environments.



### MULTIMODAL REASONING

Combining all modalities enables richer reasoning and more human-like intelligence.

POWERING THE NEXT  
GENERATION OF AI  
SYSTEMS



Robotics



Autonomous  
Vehicles



Augmented  
Reality



Intelligent  
Assistants



Surveillance



Healthcare



and More...

## PART 3

# Capabilities & the Frontier

From neat demos to production tools — what these systems do today, and the 2026 architecture shift you should know.





WHAT THEY DO TODAY

# Six capabilities you can use now



## Text → Image

Generate original visuals from a prompt.



## Inpainting

Replace or fix part of an image seamlessly.



## Outpainting

Extend a picture beyond its borders.



## Super-resolution

Upscale and sharpen low-res images.



## Image → Image

Restyle or transform an existing photo.



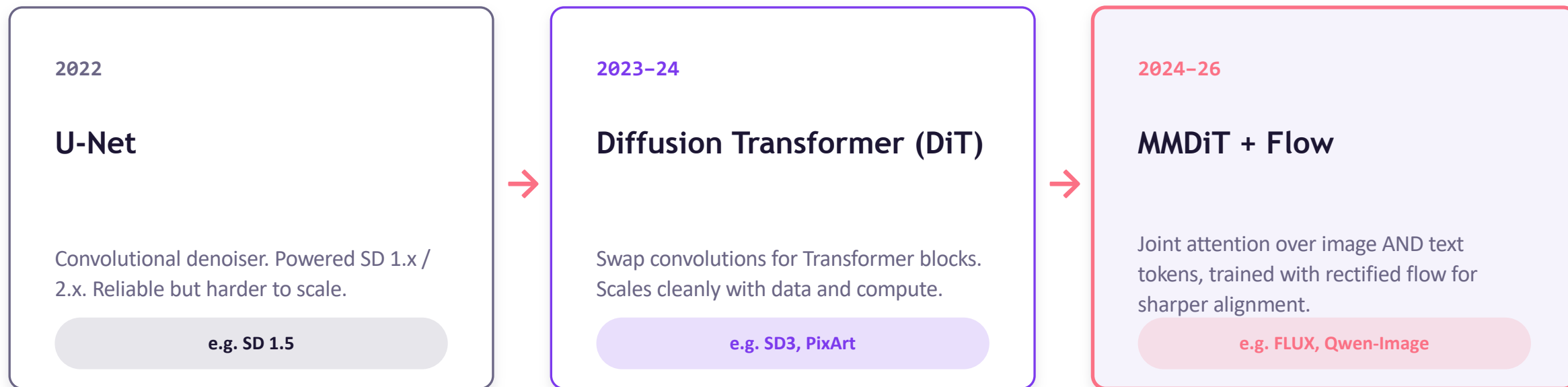
## Controlled gen

Guide structure with poses, edges, depth.

## HOW WE GOT HERE

# The backbone evolved: U-Net → DiT → MMDiT

The denoiser at the heart of diffusion has changed shape. Early models used a U-Net; the field then borrowed the Transformer — the same architecture behind LLMs — and finally fused image and text tokens into one attention stream.



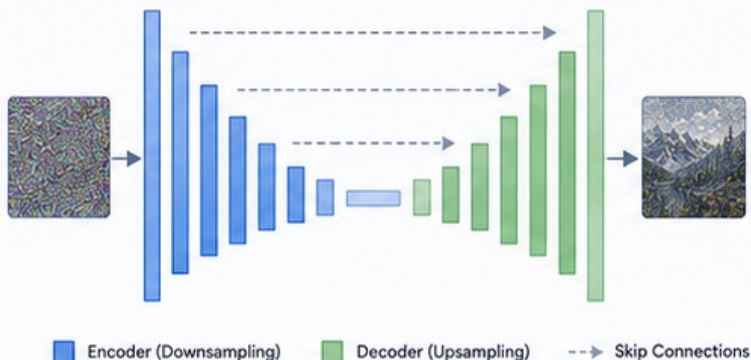
# THE EVOLUTION OF DIFFUSION MODEL ARCHITECTURES

From U-Net to Transformers and Beyond

2015–2021

## U-NET

Convolutional Neural Networks  
for Diffusion Models

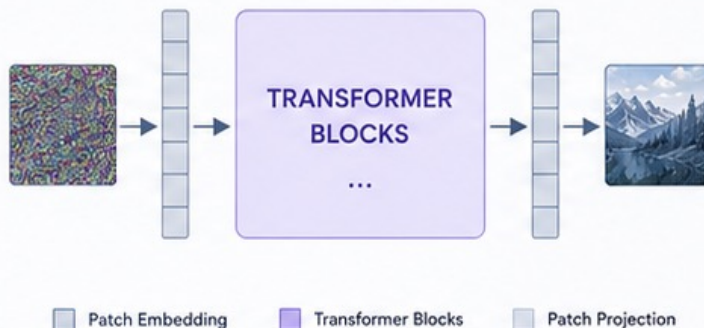


- Convolutional architecture with skip connections
- Local receptive fields and hierarchical features
- Proven success for early diffusion models (DDPM, Improved DDPM, etc.)

2022–2023

## DIFFUSION TRANSFORMER (DiT)

Transformers for Diffusion Models

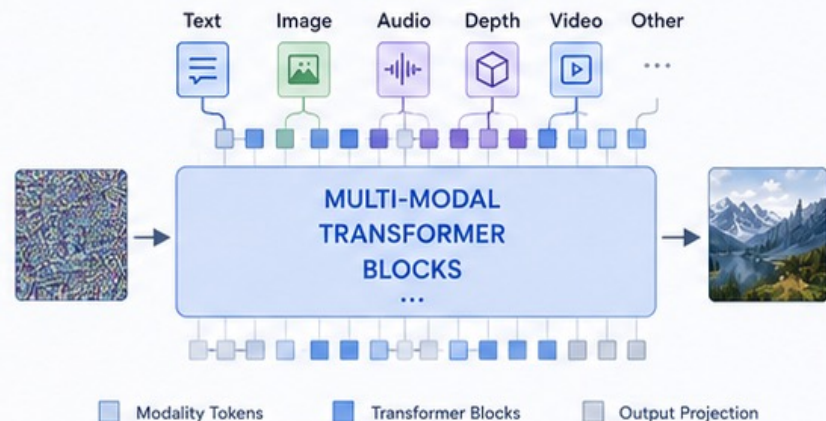


- Replaces convolutions with global self-attention
- Captures long-range dependencies effectively
- Scales better with model size and data
- Foundation for scalable generative modeling

2024+

## MMDiT (MULTI-MODAL DiT)

Unified Multi-Modal Diffusion Transformer



- Extends DiT to multiple modalities and tasks
- Unified representation across diverse data types
- Enables richer generation and understanding
- Powers next-gen AI systems and applications

2015–2021

### The Foundation

U-Net establishes the standard  
for diffusion models.

2022–2023

### The Transformer Shift

DiT introduces transformers,  
unlocking scalability and global context.

2024+

### The Multi-Modal Future

MMDiT unifies modalities,  
driving the future of generative AI.

# Two roads to the same goal

Today's leading systems split into two philosophies. Knowing the difference helps you pick the right tool — and read the headlines.



## Diffusion / Flow

Iteratively denoise a latent. Champions of raw visual fidelity, open weights, and fine-grained control.

**Strengths** texture, photorealism, open ecosystem, editability

Examples: FLUX.1 / FLUX.2, SDXL & SD3.5, Qwen-Image



## Autoregressive / Unified

Treat pixels as tokens and predict them inside one multimodal model — so it can reason about an image the way it reasons about text.

**Strengths** prompt-following, text rendering, world knowledge, editing

Examples: GPT-Image series, Gemini 'Nano Banana' image models

*The lines are blurring — the frontier is unified multimodal systems, not lone pixel generators.*

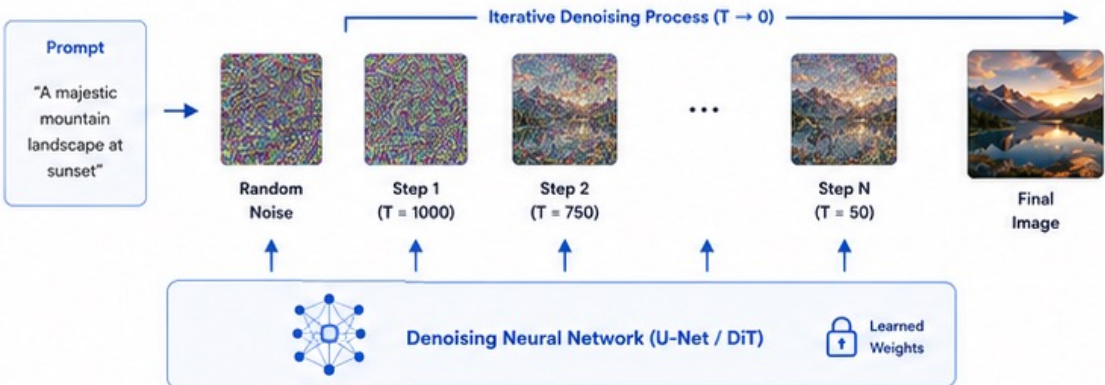


# DIFFUSION MODELS vs. MULTIMODAL AUTOREGRESSIVE MODELS

Two Powerful Paradigms for Generative AI

## DIFFUSION-BASED IMAGE GENERATION

Iterative Denoising to Create Images



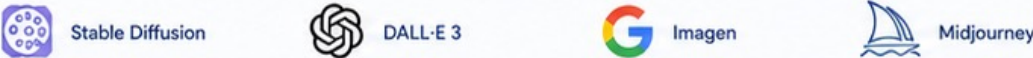
### KEY CHARACTERISTICS

- Generation Process**: Iterative refinement over many steps (typically 20-100+ steps)
- Output Quality**: Excellent image quality and detail
- Computational Pattern**: High compute per step, sequential process
- Strengths**: State-of-the-art quality, diverse outputs, strong for images
- Limitations**: Slower inference, more steps to generate

### BEST SUITED FOR

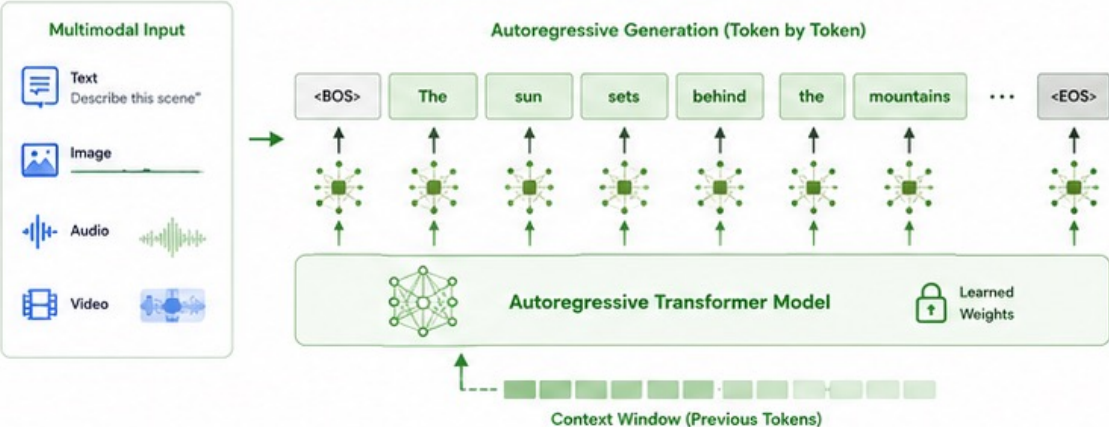
- High-quality image generation
- Creative and artistic tasks
- Applications where quality is paramount
- Domains with smaller discrete output spaces

### POPULAR EXAMPLES



## MULTIMODAL AUTOREGRESSIVE AI SYSTEMS

Next-Token Prediction Across Multiple Modalities



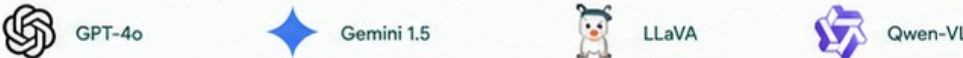
### KEY CHARACTERISTICS

- Generation Process**: One token at a time, left-to-right generation
- Output Quality**: Highly coherent, consistent, and controllable
- Computational Pattern**: Lower compute per token, efficient inference
- Strengths**: Scalable, fast inference, handles any modality
- Limitations**: Can be less effective for ultra-high fidelity images

### BEST SUITED FOR

- Multimodal understanding and generation
- Conversational AI and agents
- Real-time applications
- Tasks requiring long-form coherence

### POPULAR EXAMPLES



## KEY DIFFERENCES AT A GLANCE

| Generation Approach                                | Output Space                               | Speed                                       | Best For                               | Modality Support                   |
|----------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| Iterative Denoising vs.  Autoregressive Prediction | Continuous (Pixels) vs.  Discrete (Tokens) | Slower (Many Steps) vs.  Faster (Per Token) | Image Quality vs.  Versatility & Scale | Primarily Images vs.  Any Modality |

WHERE IT PAYS OFF

# From lab to industry



## Marketing & e-commerce

On-brand product shots, ad variants, and localized creative at scale.



## Media & entertainment

Concept art, storyboards, VFX, and rapid pre-visualization.



## Design & architecture

Mood boards, façade studies, and fast iteration on visual ideas.



## Healthcare & science

Image enhancement, data augmentation, and molecular design support.



## Gaming

Textures, assets, and world art generated and iterated in minutes.



## Education & training

Custom diagrams, illustrations, and visual explainers on demand.



# AI IN ACTION ACROSS INDUSTRIES

. Transforming Workflows. Enhancing Creativity. Delivering Impact. .



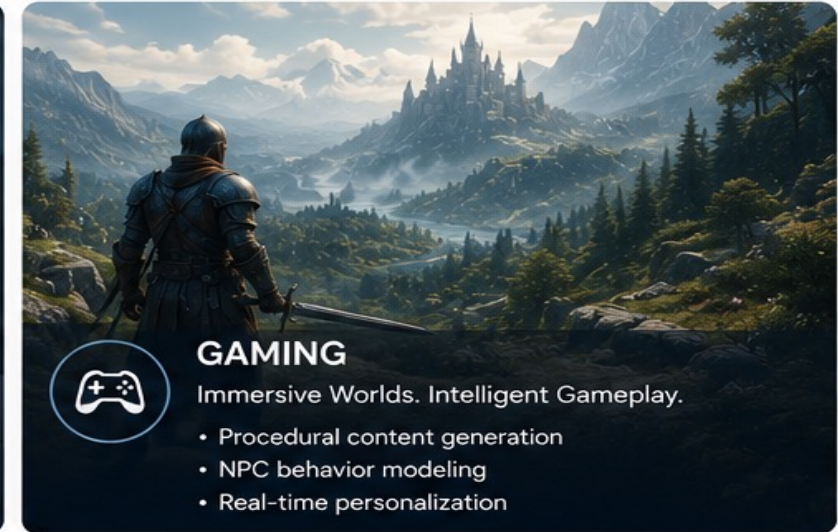
**MARKETING**  
Smarter Campaigns. Deeper Engagement.

- Audience segmentation
- Content generation
- Predictive analytics



**HEALTHCARE**  
Better Outcomes. Smarter Care.

- Medical image analysis
- Drug discovery
- Patient risk prediction



**GAMING**  
Immersive Worlds. Intelligent Gameplay.

- Procedural content generation
- NPC behavior modeling
- Real-time personalization



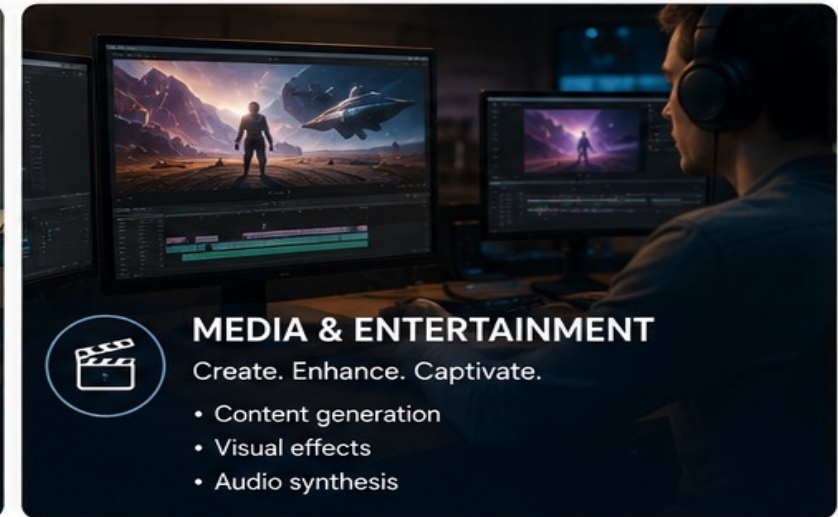
**ARCHITECTURE**  
Design Smarter. Build Better.

- Generative design
- 3D modeling
- Sustainability analysis



**EDUCATION**  
Personalized Learning. Better Results.

- Adaptive learning paths
- Automated assessments
- Intelligent tutoring systems



**MEDIA & ENTERTAINMENT**  
Create. Enhance. Captivate.

- Content generation
- Visual effects
- Audio synthesis



AI is not just a technology—it's a catalyst for innovation across every industry and every workflow.



Increase  
Efficiency



Drive  
Innovation



Enhance  
Experiences



Shape the  
Future

## THE HONEST PART

# Limits, failure modes & responsible use

World-class practice means naming what these systems still get wrong — and using them responsibly.



### Anatomy & fine structure

Hands, fingers, text, and symmetry still slip — improving, not solved.



### Deepfakes & consent

Realistic fakes of real people demand consent, disclosure, and care.



### Resolution & composition

Older models favoured fixed sizes; complex multi-object scenes can drift.



### IP & provenance

Respect rights; favour watermarking and content credentials (C2PA).



### Faithfulness & bias

Outputs inherit biases in training data; prompts aren't always followed exactly.



### Regulation is arriving

Disclosure and transparency rules (e.g. the EU AI Act) are now in play.



## PART 4

# Hands-On

Two short demos to make it real — one open-source, one API. The code is in your reference notebooks.



# Stable Diffusion text-to-image

Run the full pipeline locally with Hugging Face diffusers — positive and negative prompts, adjustable strength.

```
stable_diffusion_t2i.py
from diffusers import StableDiffusionPipeline
import torch

pipe = StableDiffusionPipeline.from_pretrained(
    "stabilityai/stable-diffusion-2-1",
    torch_dtype=torch.float16,
).to("cuda")

image = pipe(
    prompt="a red fox in fresh snow, golden hour",
    negative_prompt="blurry, extra limbs",
    num_inference_steps=30,
    guidance_scale=7.5,
).images[0]

image.save("fox.png")
```

## What to watch

- 1 Model loads VAE + U-Net + text encoder — Part 1 in code
- 2 negative\_prompt steers AWAY from unwanted traits
- 3 steps & guidance\_scale = your quality/creativity dials

# Image generation via the OpenAI API

When you want top quality without managing GPUs, a hosted model is one call away. Same idea — text in, pixels out.

```
generate_with_api.py

from openai import OpenAI
import base64

client = OpenAI()

resp = client.images.generate(
    model="gpt-image-1",
    prompt="a serene mountain lake at dawn, "
          "photorealistic, soft mist",
    size="1024x1024",
)

img = base64.b64decode(resp.data[0].b64_json)
open("lake.png", "wb").write(img)
```

## Open- vs hosted

- 1 Hosted: best quality, no infra, pay per image
- 2 Open: full control, private, customizable, free to run
- 3 Same mental model — the prompt is the steering wheel

IF YOU REMEMBER NOTHING ELSE

# Three ideas to carry home



## Generation is denoising in reverse

Models learn to remove noise, then sculpt images out of pure static. Latent space makes it affordable.

01



## Words steer pixels through a shared map

Embeddings + CLIP + contrastive learning let meaning guide every denoising step.

02



## The frontier is unified & multimodal

U-Net → Transformer → one model that reasons across text, image, and beyond — used responsibly.

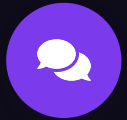
03



THANK YOU

# Questions & conversation

*You typed a sentence — and now you know how the machine paints it.*



Let's discuss your use cases — and where you'd take this next.